

COLD OPEN

FADE IN:

TITLE SEQUENCE FOR THE TV SHOW "LORD OF THE SWINE"

QUICK CUTS of contestants hacking at different types of pork. CLOSE UP shots of different ingredients. The JUDGES pick through and sample each element of the dish. SHOTS of the judges expressing delight and disgust.

JUDGE SYMON

So many interesting things going on in
my mouth right now.

CUT TO:

JUDGE ANDERSON

These smoked jowls... have me
salivating.

CUT TO:

JUDGE GUARNASCHELLI

The pig wouldn't even eat this.

GRAPHIC of a pig wearing a crown and sitting on a throne. A knife goes through the head and it SQUEALS.

INT. TELEVISION STUDIO - DAY

A kitchen with dirty pots and pans covers the countertops. ALLEN JAMES, an average-looking, sharp-dressed man with perfectly groomed hair and a winning smile (30s), stands next to the row of JUDGES. RALPH and BRIANNA, contestants on the show, stand side by side before them.

ALLEN

(into camera)

Welcome back to Lord of the Swine. You just witnessed three rounds of intense culinary battles. The air reeks of burnt fat and anticipation. The two contestants put their blood, sweat, and tears into their pork. After careful consideration, the judges have made their decision.

Tension builds. The two contestants look at each other and back at Allen. EXTREME CUTS of the contestants, the food, and the judges.

ALLEN(CONT'D)

Ralph. I'm sorry. Y-You've been
butchered.

Ralph's face drops. He tears up.

JUDGE SYMON

Ralph, your pig's ears were pickled to
perfection... but your loins... were
subpa--

ALLEN

--I'm sorry, can we...

We PULL BACK. The CAMERA OPERATORS GROAN. The judges look
annoyed. A FOOD PRODUCER tosses her clipboard on the ground.

ALLEN(CONT'D)

I totally butchered that butcher line.
(chuckles)
Let's... let's take it back.

FOOD PRODUCER

Back to your marks!

Everyone gets back into position. Judge Symon takes a deep
breath.

JUDGE SYMON

(under his breath)
Just... one more taping.

ALLEN

What's that?

Judge Symon nervously looks over at Allen.

JUDGE SYMON

Uh, I said my toes need scraping.

Judge Anderson gives Judge Symon a confused look and shakes
her head.

JUDGE SYMON(CONT'D)

I gotta. Take care of that.

ALLEN

Yea, that's... pretty vile.
(then)
So, when you're done abrading your
foot, do you plan on coming to the
(MORE)

ALLEN (CONT'D)
house warming tomorrow night?

JUDGE SYMON
No, I can't make it. Got my son's
basketball game.

ALLEN
Well, when you get sick of that, you
should bounce on over. Each table will
present different types of cuisines
from around the globe.

JUDGE SYMON
Yea, I'm not--

ALLEN
--Got this up-and-coming chef to cater
it. Told him I'd get him on the show.

JUDGE SYMON
I don't wa--

ALLEN
--You think it'd be tacky if I got an
ice sculpture? I can't shake that
idea.

JUDGE SYMON
Allen! Can we focus on this, please? I
want to get the hell out of here.

Allen throws his hands up and makes a "Sheesh!" expression.
He turns around and discreetly takes a flask out of his
jacket pocket, swigs it, then puts it back. He looks toward
the contestants. Ralph's balling. Brianna tries to contain
her excitement.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
(to Ralph)
Hey, buddy. Pull yourself together.
You're a grown-ass man... That being
said, try and have a similar reaction.
That was perfect.

He gives a wink and a thumbs up to Brianna.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

EXT. ALLEN'S PASADENA HOME - ESTABLISHING - NIGHT

A beautiful home. A few balloons on the mailbox signifying a party inside.

INT. BATHROOM - NIGHT

Allen stands in front of the mirror taking deep breaths.

ALLEN

You made it, bud... You got your dream house... Your job? Going strong. You belong here. You matter.

He swigs a flask and puts it in his jacket pocket.

ALLEN(CONT'D)

Now. Time to get back in there and be the hostess with the mostess... uh, host with the m-- Whatever.

He throws on a fake smile and walks out.

INT. KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS

A few COOKS rush around the kitchen. Flames are on high underneath pots and pans. Glasses of champagne get poured. WAITERS pick up hors d'oeuvres and head out the back door. Allen walks through.

ALLEN

Great job everyone. Keep those tiny blocks of meat and cheese flowing!

He grabs a glass of champagne from a passing waiter and snacks on some dip.

ALLEN(CONT'D)

Oh, man. That tapenade... tastes like it was made by the tap-e-GODS.

(chuckles)

That's you guys. Don't you forget it.

The HEAD CHEF screams at a LANKY WAITER. Allen finishes his glass and observes.

HEAD CHEF

Listen, next time one of the guests stabs themselves with a toothpick,

(MORE)

HEAD CHEF (CONT'D)

don't come crying to me. You tell them
to take a breath before shoveling more
food into their GLUTTONOUS FUCKING
MOUTHS!... that clear?

WAITER

Uh. Y-yes, sir.

CHEF

Good. Take these.

The chef hands the lanky waiter a tray of champagne.

ALLEN

Keep up that energy, Chef! You'll be a
TV personality in no time!

Allen grabs a glass off of the tray, gulps it, grabs another,
and heads outside to--

EXT. BACKYARD PARTY - CONTINUOUS

A large sign above the door reads "If You Can't Take The
Heat, Get Out Of The House Warming Party". Guests wander the
yard. Allen notices TOM BIERMAN, an executive producer on the
food channel, and Allen's boss, speaking with another
PRODUCER.

TOM

I mean, there're only so many episodes
you could do on one animal. It was
bound to happen sooner or later.

PRODUCER

What are you going to do with Allen?

TOM

Well. He's definitely a handful, but a
hell of a host, so I'm going to try
an--

The producer notices Allen.

PRODUCER

(whisper)

--He's walking this way. Are you going
to tell him now?

Tom looks over at Allen. His eyes widen.

TOM
(whispers frantically)
I... I can't. He's got that look in
his eye.

Allen stumbles a little as he walks up to them. The producer
smiles and hustles out of there.

ALLEN
Mr. Bierman! So glad you could make
it.

TOM
Hey, Allen! The place is beautiful.

They cheers.

TOM(CONT'D)
How, uh. How much does something like
this cost?

ALLEN
Well, I definitely splurged. She, uh,
she wasn't cheap. Let's just say that.
I'm happy with her though.

TOM
Well, I'd have to say, she's worth
every penny. Unlike someone I know...

Tom nudges Allen with his elbow. They share a hearty LAUGH.

TOM(CONT'D)
(clears throat)
Well, I've noticed you've got quite
the spread. I'm gonna... check out the
seafood bar.

ALLEN
Mmm. Sorry, yea, I should probably
mingle a bit. I'll see you around, if
not, we'll chat more on Monday. Try
the shrimp ceviche!

Tom turns around and makes a "yikes" face. Allen walks
through the party and runs into AARON SANCHEZ and his WIFE.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
Hey, Aaron!

He corrects himself. He rolls his R's and says it with a

Mexican accent.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
Sorry. Aar`on. Am I saying it right?
Aar`on Sanchez?

AARON SANCHEZ
Yea, that's... that's correct.

ALLEN
Have you guys seen Bobby around?

They shake their heads "no".

ALLEN
Huh. Who knew Bobby Flay would be such
a Bobby FLAKE. Right?!
(laughs)
Enjoy the taco stand. It's muy
caliente!

Allen continues through the party.

AARON SANCHEZ
(to wife)
I'm guessing Tom hasn't mentioned
anything yet.

Allen sees GUY FIERI with ANNE BURRELL. He goes in between
them.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
Woah! Look at these two dumb blondes.
I'm kidding!
(to Guy)
Oh, hey. Is that donkey sauce in your
pocket? Or a raging boner? I'm joking!
(laughs)
Enjoy the party.

He slaps Guy on the back, finishes his drink, and looks over
his shoulder.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
Is that Duff?!

Allen grabs a glass from a passing waiter and walks away.

GUY FIERI
Glad that stupid pork show's over. I
can't stand that douche.

ANNE BURRELL

I know... and that says a lot coming from you.

Guy gives her a look. Allen walks up to DUFF GOLDMAN at a food table.

ALLEN

I knew it. I can spot that soul patch and bald head from a mile away! How are ya?

DUFF

I'm doin' all right. Dig the sculpture.

ANGLE ON: An ice sculpture of Allen's head wearing a crown on the body of a pig.

ALLEN

Thanks! Hey, when are we gonna get you on Lord Of The Swine? You judge all these baking shows, might as well switch it up, right?

DUFF

(chuckles)

Good one, man. No ones judging that show anymore.

ALLEN

What? I mean, I know a few judges got a little sick in the past, but we stopped with the "Freaks Cook Pigs Feet" week. The freaks were upset, but the pigs were sure happy.

DUFF

No, I'm talking about the show getting canceled.

ALLEN

... What?

Allen slowly drops the fake smile.

DUFF

Oh sh-- Did you not. Tom didn't mention anything to you?

ALLEN

I was just talking to him. He never...
I can't believe this.

DUFF

Oof. I'm sorry, I figured you knew. I
mean, everyone kno--

ALLEN

--Three years at the network and I
have to find out we're canceled
through the fuckin' Ace of Cakes guy?!

DUFF

Woah, alright.

Allen turns to Tom at the seafood bar and clenches his fist.

ALLEN

Hey, Bierman!

Tom looks over and sees Allen marching towards him with rage
in his eyes.

TOM

Uh oh.

Tom scurries away. Allen sprints and tackles him into the ice
sculpture.

EXT. WTC AGENCY - ESTABLISHING - DAY

REBECCA(O.S)

Well, the good news is, he's not
pressing charges.

INT. REBECCA'S OFFICE - DAY

Allen sits across from his agent, REBECCA, A stern-looking
woman (40s) with a blue tooth in her ear.

REBECCA(CONT'D)

Bad news is, you'll never work for him
or any of those networks again.

ALLEN

You know what? Good riddance. What
kind of exec keeps that news from the
host?

REBECCA

One that knew that his talent has a tendency to become unstable under the influence of alcohol.

ALLEN

Last year's Christmas karaoke party was totally justified. I called dibs on *Jingle Bell Rock* and Hal knew that.

REBECCA

(sighs)

Instability aside, you're still my client, so let's take a look at your other options.

Rebecca puts on her glasses and looks at her computer.

REBECCA(CONT'D)

So, there's a travel show that's coming out on this new online platform called FoodTube...

ALLEN

Next.

She looks over at Allen.

REBECCA

I'm sorry. Did I say options? As in plural? I meant your only option right now after the stunt you pulled.

ALLEN

I can't do a travel show! I'm a food competition guy! Plus, I just bought a house here.

REBECCA

Exactly. If you want to keep that house, and me as your agent, you need some sort of income.

ALLEN

But to go from television to the internet? That's like... The Beatles playing in a run-down pub.

REBECCA

Please don't compare a revolutionary band to the host of a pig show.

ALLEN
(under his breath)
Psh. Number one pig show on the
network two years in a row...

REBECCA
Also, I wouldn't knock internet shows.
There are Youtube personalities that
pull in seven figures every year.

Allen perks up.

ALLEN
What're the locations?

Rebecca looks at her computer.

REBECCA
I don't have a full list yet, but
first stop is... Thailand.

Allen SIGHS.

ALLEN
Alright... Set up a meeting.

REBECCA
Oh, that won't be necessary. They're
as desperate as you are.

INT. ALLEN'S KITCHEN - EVENING

After he pours himself a glass of wine, Allen smashes a couple cloves of garlic with the back of his knife, tosses it into a blender filled with ingredients, and blends it on high. He looks over as the NEWS reports in the other room. They're showing clips of horrific events in a foreign country. He shakes his head.

ALLEN
Jesus...

He turns the blender off. He tastes the sauce, approves, and dollops some onto his plate that's already filled with risotto and sauteed vegetables. He takes a piece of salmon out of the oven, sprinkles some fresh dill on top, and places it on the sauce. His cell phone RINGS. It reads "**DOUCHEBAG**".

ALLEN
(into phone)
What?

INTERCUT:

INT. BACK OF LIMO - EVENING

TYLER JAMES, an extremely handsome man (28), sips champagne and adjusts the tie on his tuxedo. He's clearly ready for an important event.

TYLER

(into phone)

Looks like all those years of me
kicking your ass finally reared its
ugly head.

ALLEN

Psh. Your ass was the one that... I
kicked yours.

TYLER

Good one.

ALLEN

Shut up. Why are you calling me?

TYLER

Mom keeps crying to me about how
you've ruined your life and whatnot.
She wants me to be a good brother and
offer you a job.

ALLEN

A job?... Doing what?

TYLER

My personal assistant. Running
errands, keeping appointments, picking
up my dog's shit. All that fun stuff.

ALLEN

(scoffs)

For your information, I already have a
job lined up. A travel show gig on
Foodtube.

TYLER

(laughing)

Foodtube?! Are you serious?

ALLEN

Uh. Yes?

TYLER

Have you ever looked at their content before? Their biggest show is a Russian grandmother and her husband cooking borscht while they tell stories from the Cold War.

ALLEN

I mean, I'd... watch that.

TYLER

Yea, right. You and about twelve other people.

ALLEN

(annoyed)

You know what? Even if it doesn't have the views right now, they didn't have Allen James before. I'm going to host the shit out of this show and put the streaming service on the map, so you and Mom can suck it!

Beat.

TYLER

That's weird, man.

ALLEN

Yea... I realized after I said it.

TYLER

Listen, I'm pulling up to my premiere. Call me when all of that blows up in your face and you fail miserably. The offer might still be on the table.

ALLEN

Oh, fu--

Tyler's limo doors open to loud fanatic SCREAMS.

TYLER

--Sorry, I can't hear you over the sounds of actual success.

Tyler hangs up.

ALLEN

Yea?!... Well!

Allen aggressively presses the end call button. He grabs his laptop off the kitchen table and types in FoodTube. The first video that pops up is called "Babushka and the Beast". He clicks on episode four. It's the Babushka dancing in the kitchen to her husband playing the accordion.

ALLEN(CONT'D)

Shit.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

INT. VAN - DAY

SUSAN GARDNER, hair in a tight bun with dark circles under her eyes (30s), watches a video on her phone.

ALLEN(V.O)

So you better get ready for some
prime-time swine!

Susan cringes. The VAN DRIVER navigates his way through a Pasadena neighborhood.

SUSAN

(to driver)

Turn on the next block.

Next to her is JEFF DAVIS, a chubby, carefree goofball (40s). He digs through his backpack.

SUSAN

You don't think he'll be this cheesy,
right?

JEFF

Eh, probably. You just have to do your
job and point him in the direction you
want the show to go. In other words...
do the opposite of what you normally
do.

Susan takes offense, but then gives in and agrees. Jeff continues to dig through his bag.

JEFF(CONT'D)

They have to be in here somewhere.

SUSAN

What are you looking for?

JEFF

My nasal strips.

He takes out different items, including a whoopee cushion.

SUSAN

The whoopee cushion? Really?

JEFF

Never know when you'll run into an
(MORE)

JEFF (CONT'D)
opportunity for a goof.
(to Mark)
Take notes, kid.

Squeezed in between some luggage in the back seat sits MARK RINEHOLD, a scrawny, bright-eyed youth (20s). Mark, not paying any attention to Jeff, films himself on his phone.

MARK
(into phone camera)
Ayyy, what's up, guys. On our way to pick up the star of the show, Allen James. That's right! You heard me correctly. The Sultan of Swine himself. Then it's off to the airport!

JEFF
(to Mark)
Is this going to go on the whole trip?

MARK
Everyone needs a side hustle.
(to driver)
Right, my man?

VAN DRIVER
This is my only hustle.

SUSAN
(to driver)
Oh, this is it coming up.

They pull up to Allen's house.

MARK
Damn!

JEFF
Huh. Son of a bitch. My cousin Marty brought me to a party here. Got stabbed by a friggin' toothpick when I was noshing on some quiche.

SUSAN
This place is ridiculous.

JEFF
Yea, it's even got a bidet. My asshole was sparkling.

MARK
Now that's class.

EXT. ALLEN'S HOUSE - DAY

Allen walks out with a couple of bags and heads towards the van. Susan gets out.

SUSAN
Hi! I'm Susan, I'm the pro-

ALLEN
Producer. Got it. Do we have a PA that
can take care of these bags for me?

SUSAN
Uh. Yes... Mark!

Mark squeezes his way out of the van.

SUSAN(CONT'D)
This is Mark.

Mark goes for a handshake.

MARK
Big fan.

He receives Allen's bags instead.

SUSAN
He'll be our PA and second camera op
throughout the series.

MARK
Don't forget editing and sound.

He opens the trunk and struggles with the bags.

ALLEN
Wow. Small crew.

SUSAN
(chuckles)
Yea, well, you know what they say
about small crews...

Allen shrugs.

SUSAN(CONT'D)
Big, uh... big hearts.

Beat.

JEFF(O.S)

Lame!

SUSAN

Alright, let's get this show on the road! Hurry it up, Mark!

Allen gets in. Susan follows. One of Allen's bags falls out of the trunk and lands on top of Mark. He lets out a SHRIEK.

INT. VAN - CONTINUOUS

Allen sits up front. Jeff pokes his head up.

JEFF

Hey, there. Name's Jeff. Camera op.

ALLEN

Hey--

Allen does a double-take.

ALLEN(CONT'D)

--Wait, why do you look so familiar?

JEFF

Uhh, I don't know. I must have that kind of face.

Jeff quickly sits back in his seat. Allen turns around.

ALLEN

Wait, no, I kicked you out of my party for abusing my bidet!

(then)

Is. Is that a whoopee cushion?

Jeff CHUCKLES nervously and puts the whoopee cushion back in his bag. Mark gets into the van and squeezes into the back. The van drives off.

SUSAN

Ok, so, here are the questions for the first interview.

Allen takes the paper, looks through, and GROANS.

SUSAN(CONT'D)

... Something wrong?

ALLEN

"Did you dream about growing your own rice when you were younger?". What kind of question is that?

SUSAN

The kind that I believe our viewers will be interested in.

ALLEN

Yea, if they don't have a pulse. You need some pizazz. I really thi--

SUSAN

--I also made this list of things to be wary of in Thailand.

Susan gives the list to everyone.

SUSAN(CONT'D)

Not to alarm anyone, but Jeff and I have learned that it's always good to take precautions.

(to Jeff)

Right?

JEFF

A guy wakes up in a Vietnamese prison one time and he never hears the end of it!

Mark leans up.

MARK

We can't drink the tap water?

SUSAN

Yea, the pipes there are pretty old and grimy. It would wreak havoc on our insides.

ALLEN

Can't wait.

SUSAN

And here are our boarding passes.

Susan hands Allen his.

ALLEN

Uhh. Mine... has a mistake. It says
(MORE)

ALLEN (CONT'D)

I'm 34E.

JEFF

Hey, plane buddy, looks like you're sittin' next to papa.

Jeff gives a thumbs up.

ALLEN

As thrilling as that sounds, are we not flying first class?

INT. AIRPLANE - DAY

Allen sits on the aisle seat. Jeff gets comfortable and takes a neck pillow out of his bag.

ALLEN

You just couldn't give up the window seat, could you?

JEFF

Well. It says my name on this ticket. Which also says 34 F. So...

(then)

At least I understand airplane etiquette. The armrest is all yours.

Allen looks down at his complimentary bag of peanuts and quickly tosses them at Jeff.

JEFF(CONT'D)

Ah, what the--

(realizing)

Psh. Jokes on you. I hoard these bad boys.

Jeff puts the bag in his pocket, wraps the pillow around his neck and puts his sleeping mask on. Allen SIGHS and tries to lean back. The seat goes a couple of inches. He waves a FLIGHT ATTENDANT over.

ALLEN

Does this thing go back any further?

The flight attendant looks at the seat and back at Allen.

FLIGHT ATTENDANT

No.

ALLEN

Of course... Ok, let me get a Vodka club.

FLIGHT ATTENDANT

Sir, you need to relax. The drink cart will be down shortly.

Allen clenches his teeth and gives the flight attendant a fake smile.

ALLEN

Just. Let me know when it comes down. Ok?

The flight attendant leaves. Allen moves around trying to get comfortable. He lays the small blanket that's provided on top of his legs, but it barely reaches his knees. Then he balls it up to use as a pillow. Finally finding a position he's happy with, he puts his eye mask on. Jeff SNORES loudly. Allen SIGHS.

CUT TO:

INT. AIRPLANE - LATER

Allen's blanket covers Jeff's head, slightly masking the snoring. Allen's dozing off. One leg fully under the seat and the other slightly into the aisle. The drink cart bashes into his knee. He jolts up, biting his lip and trying to hold back a scream.

ALLEN

Ffffffffff.

FLIGHT ATTENDANT

Sir. The drink cart is here.

EXT. PHUKET HOTEL - NIGHT

The hotel looks like it's standing on its last leg. Two EMPLOYEES play cards in the front. Allen stares at two raggedy stray dogs eating a carcass next to a food cart. A sign on the food cart reads "Scorpion: Ten Baht". The rest of the team takes the bags out of the cab.

ALLEN

Getting a nice murder vibe from this place.

SUSAN

The outside's a bit rough, but the inside is... well, it's also kind of rough. You get used to it though.

JEFF

Look at the bright side. The beach is only a ten-minute walk from here.

ALLEN

And the other direction?

JEFF

I think it's the sewer runoff.

ALLEN

Makes sense.

MARK

Hey, is anyone else hungry?

ALLEN

Did the mentioning of a sewer runoff really just stir up your appetite?

MARK

Uh... I guess. That and my news feed.

Mark shows Allen his phone with endless pictures of food and the hashtag "mukbang".

SUSAN

We have an early morning tomorrow, so we should stick with room service.

JEFF

The lobby bar serves food. Team dinner?

ALLEN

Pass. We do have our own rooms, correct?

SUSAN

Yea, I'll check us in.

MARK

Sweet! I didn't know we had our own rooms.

JEFF

They have their own rooms. You're bunkin' with me.

ALLEN

(to Mark)

I hope you kept your earplugs from the flight.

(then)

Let's go. I need to scrub off that cab ride and then get to work on these questions.

Allen grabs his bags and walks inside. Susan looks at Jeff.

JEFF

Just remember what I said in the van.
Time to put all of those self-help books to good use.

She agrees, takes a breath, and walks inside. Mark takes the last bag out of the trunk. Jeff walks by the two employees playing cards.

JEFF(CONT'D)

(sarcastic)

Don't get up guys, we got it.

INT. JEFF AND MARK'S ROOM - NIGHT

We hear scratching outside of the door.

MARK(O.S)

The key's not working.

JEFF(O.S)

You gotta... you gotta swipe it.

MARK(O.S)

I did. I've been swiping. It's not--

JEFF(O.S)

--No not like that, you're--

MARK(O.S)

--I don't understand what I'm doing wrong.

JEFF(O.S)

--Give it to me. Give me the key.

The door opens. Mark and Jeff bring all of the equipment into their room. It's one of the master suites, but that isn't saying much here.

MARK

Whaaaaat?! We're livin' that suite life!

Mark jumps and lays flat on the bed.

JEFF

Eh-eh-eh. Don't get comfortable. The only reason why we have this room in the first place is so we can set up an edit bay.

MARK

Alright, that's no problem.

JEFF

And because it comes with a couch.

Mark looks over at the couch.

MARK

Gotcha. Still a bomb-ass couch though.

He hops off the bed and plops on the couch, but it's hard as a rock. He tries to play it cool.

JEFF

We should start setting up, but before we do.

Jeff takes out a bag of tiny liquor bottles from his backpack.

JEFF(CONT'D)

A toast!

Jeff hands Mark a bottle. Mark LAUGHS.

MARK

How did you get these through customs?

JEFF

Under three point four ounces. If you travel as much as I do, you learn the tricks of the trade, my friend.

They hold up the bottles. Mark has his phone pointed towards

Jeff.

JEFF(CONT'D)

Here's to a good shoot and the
adventures that lay ahead.

They cheers and guzzle them down.

JEFF(CONT'D)

Alright! Let's get to work.

MARK

Oh, before we get this room all messy,
can you take a picture of me
Goldbluming on the bed? Gonna throw in
the hashtag "Thai Guy".

He holds his phone out. Jeff looks at it for a beat and
aggressively grabs it out of Mark's hand.

MARK

Ah, what the hell?

JEFF

What kind of idiot would do something
like that?

Beat.

JEFF(CONT'D)

If you're Goldbluming, you should use
the hashtag "That Fly Thai Guy".

INT. ALLEN'S ROOM - NIGHT

Allen checks the room out. He grimaces at a dead mouse caught
in a trap.

ALLEN

I feel ya, bud.

He turns the TV on. It's his brother's latest action movie
dubbed over. He immediately turns it off. He sits on the edge
of the bed and rubs his face. He lays back and takes a deep
breath. The legs snap and the bed collapses. Allen just lays
there staring at the ceiling. His self-pity is interrupted by
a knock on the door. He opens it up to Susan.

SUSAN

Hey, sorry, I--

She looks over at the collapsed bed.

ALLEN

Just a perfect representation of this trip so far.

SUSAN

(clears throat)

Um, so... I don't think you fully understand the type of show we're trying to make here, so I'd, um. I'd appreciate it if you didn't... make any changes.

ALLEN

I understand that it's going to put people to sleep. Your questions aren't interesting. At all.

Allen bends down next to the bed.

SUSAN

(scoffs)

Excuse me? The questions are just a starting point. It'll lead into discussions about their pasts and love for cooking.

Allen puts one of the legs back under the bed.

ALLEN

You really think people will want to click on that? Do you know the types of videos that are going viral nowadays? People eating spicy food, cats getting scared of pickles... whatever the hell a mukbang is.

SUSAN

Those things have nothing to do wi--

ALLEN

--Point being... we have competition. We have to do outlandish things that'll stand out from that competition. Life is chaos, Susan. People want mind-numbing entertainment to help them forget that.

He jams the other leg under the bed.

SUSAN

(annoyed)

Look, I want this show to get views just as much as you do, but not like that. There are still people out there who crave some sort of human connection, not more nonsense jammed down their throats.

Allen SIGHS and stands up.

ALLEN

Alright, I'll tell you what. Since you're so passionate about this, for whatever reason, then we'll stick with your questions... but, after I get those over with, I'm going off-script.

SUSAN

(stern)

I don't know who you think you are, but I'm the producer of this show. You're asking my questions. Nothing more. This isn't up for debate.

Susan walks out and slams the door behind her.

Beat.

The bed collapses again.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

EXT. NAM YOI RESTAURANT - DAY

Allen leans against the wall sipping coffee out of a to-go cup as Jeff gets his camera ready. Mark's off to the side holding the boom mic as Susan stands behind Jeff.

JEFF

Ok, so, before you walk in, I nee--
(notices coffee)
Would. Would you mind putting the
coffee down?

Allen tosses the cup. Susan SIGHS.

SUSAN

Pick that up, Mark.

Mark, still holding the boom mic, runs over and awkwardly picks it up trying not to disturb the mixer on his belt.

JEFF

Ok, uh, I'm going to need you to look
in the camera and say, "Man, something
sure smells good! Let's go see what
Lawans-a-cookin'!".

ALLEN

I'm not saying that.

JEFF

Wha- Alright. We'll focus on dialogue
during the voice-over, I guess.
Just... just walk into the restaurant.

Allen walks towards the door.

JEFF(CONT'D)

Wait. Don't. I'm not set up yet.

Allen walks back. Jeff points the camera at him. Allen waits for a signal. There isn't one.

ALLEN

Can I go?

JEFF

Oh, yea. Walk in.

Allen shakes his head and walks into the restaurant. He walks

back out.

ALLEN
Are we done here?

JEFF
Let's do one more. Just try not to
shake your head in disgust this time.

INT. NAM YOI RESTAURANT - KITCHEN - DAY

Susan stands behind a two-camera set up. Jeff works a steady camera. Mark holds a boom mic. LAWAN, the female owner and chef (70s), cuts up some Thai basil as Allen tosses ingredients into a pot.

LAWAN
And then add the coconut milk.

Allen adds a cup into the pot. It turns it into a vibrant orange color with sprinkles of red, green, and white from the peppers and onions.

ALLEN
So what made you decide to open this
place up?

LAWAN
I've always loved to cook. After my
prostitution days, I saved up enough
money to buy the building and fix it
up.

Lawan adds the Thai basil.

ALLEN
Woah, back up. Your what days?

Susan CLEARS HER THROAT. Allen looks up at her, then back at Lawan.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
So, tell me, Lawan. Did you... did you
dream of growing your own rice when
you were younger?

Lawan looks up at him, confused.

LAWAN
No... I don't know anyone who would
ever dream of that.

Allen slowly looks over to Susan (told you). She gives a "move on" hand gesture.

ALLEN
And what would you say your favorite
spice is?

Lawan SIGHS.

LAWAN
Cumin. Very earthy.

ALLEN
Wow. Mine too. That's... interesting.

The boom mic slowly goes into frame.

SUSAN
Mark!

MARK
(snaps out of it)
My bad.

Allen looks around the room. A COOK is in the corner, scrolling through her phone. Jeff's barely paying attention. Mark's YAWNING and nodding off. Susan shakes her head, points to her paper, and mouths "keep going". He squints his eyes and focuses his attention back to Lawan.

ALLEN
Hey, Lawan? Tell me... What's your
favorite type of liquor?

Lawan smiles.

INT. NAM YOI RESTAURANT - LATER

Similar camera set up as before. Allen and Lawan sit across from each other. On the table between them, bowls of Thai curry and half a bottle of clear liquor. They both take a shot. Susan shakes her head, annoyed.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
Ah, c'mon! No need to be bashful.
Pretend like the cameras aren't even
here.

LAWAN
Oh, alright. I don't want to get into
too much detail, but I will say
(MORE)

LAWAN (CONT'D)
this... anal is underrated.

Lawan grins. Susan SIGHS.

JEFF
(under his breath)
I couldn't agree more.

SUSAN
(to Jeff and Mark)
This is disgusting. This conversation
has nothing to do with what the show's
supposed to be about.

MARK
I don't know. I'm learning a lot.

Susan makes a "wrap it up" hand gesture towards Allen.

ALLEN
(into camera)
Ok, we're almost out of time, but
before we say goodbye, we thought we'd
spice up the final portion of this
interview with some homegrown Thai
chilis from Lawan's garden!

Susan looks confused. The cook walks in with a plate of
chilis. Lawan and Allen each grab one, cheers, and take a
bite. Mark records it on his phone.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
Huh, not too ba-- oof. That, uh. That
sneaks up on ya.
(clears throat)
Ok. First question...

Allen COUGHS.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
Woo! Oh, boy. This stuff isn't a joke.

SUSAN
His face is turning pretty red.

JEFF
Violet, you're turning violet!
(chuckles)
Right?... Willy Wonka.

SUSAN
I got it, Jeff.

ALLEN
I can't even ta-- My eyes... won't
stop watering.

Allen stands up and knocks the table over.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
What the hell is this?! Can someo-- I
need water!

Lawan LAUGHS. The cook runs in with a glass of water. Allen
takes a big gulp, but then spits it out into Lawan's face.
She SCREAMS and covers her eyes.

COOK
You just spit chili water in her face!

SUSAN
Why did you do that?!

ALLEN
It might be tap water!

COOK
It's filtered!

ALLEN
I-I'm sorry!

Jeff's CRACKING UP. Allen rubs a napkin on his face.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
Shit! I just got some in my own eyes!

Lawan punches Allen in the face.

ALLEN
Ow! What the f-- What's happening!?

LAWAN
Pussy.

ALLEN
Oh, shut up, you old bitch!

Susan rubs her fingers between her eyes and shakes her head.

SUSAN
Oh, my God.

HARD CUT TO:

INT. HOTEL LOBBY BAR - NIGHT

The team is posted up at the lobby bar. Mark re-watches the video on his phone. Allen has a bag of ice over his eye. The BARTENDER fills up their drinks.

JEFF
So... what did we learn?

MARK
That Thai women can pack a punch.

SUSAN
And that maybe next time we should
just stick to my script.

ALLEN
Susan, I'm pretty sure Lawan was going
to face plant into her bowl of curry
if I kept asking your questions.

SUSAN
It's better than learning about anal
from a seventy-year-old woman!

JEFF
Ehh.

ALLEN
You talk about human connection and
then have me ask her what her favorite
spice is. Who gives a shit? No wonder
why you guys were so desperate for a
host.

SUSAN
Oh. You're really going to call us out
for being desperate? Tell me, why was
it that you were available to work on
this show?

Allen stares at her for a beat.

ALLEN
... My show was canceled.

SUSAN

Yea, and instead of taking a severance package, you speared your EP into an ice sculpture!

Allen clenches his teeth and looks the other way.

ALLEN

How... how did you know about that?

SUSAN

Did you really think we wouldn't look into why the host of a hit show doesn't have any other network options?

JEFF

(clears throat)

Plus, I, uh, I caught the tail end where you tried shoving shrimp ceviche in his mouth.

SUSAN

You act as if you're better than this... but everyone here knows that you're just as desperate.

Allen stares at them.

ALLEN

I'm taking a walk.

He gets up, grabs a bottle from behind the bar, and leaves the hotel.

SUSAN

Where are you go-- You can't just go out by yourself! That's number two on the list!

ALLEN(O.S)

Fuck your list!

Beat.

BARTENDER

Someone has to pay for that...

EXT. BEACH - NIGHT

Allen swigs and follows tangled-up telephone wires all the way to the beach. Lightning FLASHES and thunder ROARS in the distance. Allen plops on the sand, staring out into the ocean. He takes another swig from the bottle and stares at it. A drop of water hits the label. He looks up and it pours.

ALLEN

God. Dammit.

He hears someone YELLING from afar. He turns around and sees a PEG LEGGED THAI WOMAN making a commotion. She's waving her arms and SCREAMING in Thai.

He gives the bottle that classic look like "What's in this stuff?".

He looks around and points to himself, questioning if she's yelling his way. She shakes her head "yes" and aggressively motions for him to come inside. He jogs her way.

INT. PEG LEGGED THAI WOMAN'S HOUSE - NIGHT

A humble home. People gather around a table, SHOUTING and LAUGHING as they drink beers and pass plates around. The peg-legged thai woman grabs a towel and puts it over Allen's shoulders.

ALLEN

Uh. Thanks. Listen, I'll just wait until the rain stops and...

She responds in Thai and shoves him in between a couple of people on the table. They all stop their conversation and look at him. The man next to him hands him a plate and says something to him in Thai. They all LAUGH and continue with what they were doing. Allen looks around, confused.

ALLEN(CONT'D)

Sorry, I don't, uh.

A thai man with a goatee and an EYEPATCH speaks English.

EYEPATCH

He said, "You look like pig shit."

ALLEN

Yea... it's, uh. Been a day. I--

EYEPATCH

--Hey. Look at me. I've got one eye...
Look at my wife.

The peg-legged woman LAUGHS and brings a giant plate of rice and fried shrimp to the table. It's topped with sliced cucumbers, peppers, and green onion. Everyone CHEERS.

EYEPATCH(CONT'D)

She's got one leg.

ALLEN

... Is this... supposed to hel--

EYEPATCH

--Stop crying. Try some khao kluk kapit.

They fill up his plate and hand him a beer. Allen looks around and smiles.

INT. HOTEL - JEFF AND MARK'S ROOM - NIGHT

Susan paces the floor. Jeff lays on the bed. Mark works with the footage.

JEFF

(to Susan)
You need to relax.

SUSAN

How can I relax, Jeff?! I just let the talent walk out into a foreign country by himself while he's intoxicated!

Beat.

JEFF

Good point.

SUSAN

I don't know what to do!

JEFF

What was all that about, anyway?

SUSAN

We had an argument the night before.
(sighs)
I tried to stand my ground like you said, but he had his own ideas.

MARK

Hey, guys. I posted Allen eating that pepper on my Instagram and... it's sorta trending.

SUSAN

First of all, don't ever post our content on your social media again! Second... do not mention that to Allen when he comes back.

JEFF

If he comes back.

Susan gives him a look.

JEFF(CONT'D)

I'm kidding! Christ, would you stop pacing and sit down for a second? You're burning a hole in the rug.

SUSAN

This isn't a joke, Jeff! This is a very serious situation--

She sits down and a large FART NOISE comes from under the chair. Susan blushes and stares wide-eyed. Mark puts his hand over his mouth. Jeff SNORTS, but holds in his laugh.

JEFF

I'm... I'm sorry. You're right. Very serious.

EXT. PEG LEGGED THAI WOMAN'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Allen walks out LAUGHING with a forty-ounce Leo in his hand. Peg Leg and Eyepatch follow behind.

ALLEN

Well, looks like the monsoon finally let up.

(then)

Uh, how do you say "thank you"?

EYEPATCH

Khàawp khun.

Allen does a slight bow.

ALLEN

Khàawp khun.

Allen walks away, but turns back around.

ALLEN(CONT'D)
If you're ever shipwrecked near
California, you'll always have a place
to stay!

They shake their heads and smile.

PEG LEG
(idiot)
Chodchea.

Allen goes on his way. He checks his phone and sees all of the missed calls and texts from Susan. He looks back toward the house, takes a deep breath, and calls her back.

SUSAN(O.S)
(from phone)
Allen! Thank god. Where are you?!

ALLEN
Hey, so, I uh, I want to apologize. I
think...
(clears throat)
I think I understand what you were
saying last night about the whole...
human connection thing. I'm going t--

Allen stares ahead.

SUSAN(O.S)
... Allen?

Four GANG MEMBERS on scooters sit in front of him. A YOUNG MAN gets off of one and walks up to Allen. He takes out a switchblade and presses it against Allen's cheek.

YOUNG MAN
(Money. Now.)
Ngein. Txn ni.

JEFF(O.S)
Allen, you missed it! I got Susan with
the whoopie cushion! It was classic!

END OF EPISODE